

Shopping & Auction



Online shopping promised a smooth path from your desktop to your doorstep. It was about getting the best deals on everything, right from cars to a pack of detergent, online, in just a few clicks without having to elbow your way through crowded shops. It was about creating an entire community of people

using the Net as a medium to buy and sell products and services. Online shopping and auction sites today have come a long way from being merely Web pages with a limited range of products and a telephone number to online malls which provide you the best products and brands, convenience, prices and security.

WINNER — JUDGES CHOICE



Fabmart couples good reviews and a choice of products with reliable service

Slow but steady. The tortoise in the crazy race among the various shopping and auction sites promises to offer consumers everything they need online. Fabmart started small, with only an online music store, but today has expanded into a number of categories such as books, computers, jewellery, groceries, movies, toys and watches. On Fabmart, you can find what you need quickly with its well-planned navigation and searches.

Every product here has extensive information listed, like reviews on music, songs, or books. Titles in the music store have 30-second audio clips so you can sample a song before buying it. This site ranks high on personalisation—you can create and save shopping lists, make wish lists, maintain address books or view purchase history. Little extras such as free gift-wrapping for toys make it a delight to shop here. It has a wide range of payment options and ships goods to over 850 locations India. Efficient customer service is one of Fabmart's strong points.

www.easybuymusic.com

Whatever e-commerce pundits had visualised e-shopping would be, Easybuymusic seems to have come the closest to achieving it. The site sells cassettes and CD titles of various genres of music—reggae, film music, classical, instrumental music—as well as movies and CD ROMs. Music buffs will enjoy reading the latest on the music scene in India and abroad. Easybuymusic also offers excellent discounts on certain titles on the site.

www.bidorbuyindia.com

Bidorbuyindia has a large number of categories and products and is always buzzing with activity, contests, crazy auctions—a glance at the homepage will tell you that. Navigation is a strong point here. The City Search feature helps you search for auctions within your city, and the efficient site map ensures that you don't get lost in Bidorbuy. It also has a gift shop. The best feature of this site is its bargain hunter.

THE OTHER NOMINEES

Shopping.rediff.com

Rediff's vast product range, convenient payment options and reliability make it an ideal place for shopping online. You can buy music, food, clothes, furniture, flowers, etc. Rediff also has a number of online stores featured such as The Bombay Store, Nike and Compaq. Rediff's gift centre has gifts for almost all occasions. Use the Gift matcher to help you make a decision according to the person you want to give a gift to and the occasion.

Top of the Web (% votes)

Baazee	48
Fabmart	18
Rediff	15
Bidorbuyindia	11
Easybuymusic	8

Baazee.com is a virtual paradise if you are scouting for stuff that you can't simply enter a store and buy off the rack (alternatively it's also a great place to get rid of stuff you don't want). Coins and stamps, antique furniture to second hand cell phones and musical instruments—it's all here and you can end up buying something at a throwaway price.

The bidding process is made easy on Baazee with features such as Autobid, which you can set to increase your bid by a particular amount so you don't

WINNER — POPULAR CHOICE



have to manually enter a bid each time. Baazee is a good place to shop for that special something.

